Grant Report

1. PROGRAMME SUMMARY

Organization Name			**Bhagavatula Charitable Trust**		
Grant Number			**G-2106-09397**		
Theme			**Promotion of Holistic Village Development**		
Name of the Programme			**Sustainable Livelihoods for Farmers and the Challenged (SLFC)**		
Grant Start Date			**01-02-2024**		
Grant End date			**31-01-2027**		
Reporting Period			**01-02-2024 TO 31-01-2025**		
Prepared by: (Name, Designation, Contact Number, Email Id)			K V Sitaramaraju, Program Director, 9247269745, srraju@bctindia.org		
Report Date			31-01-2025		
Total Approved Budget ₹ Cr			**57,400,000**		
Year-wise approved vs. disbursement and expenditure of Grant Funds					
Details	**Y 1**	**Y2**	**Y3**	**Y4**	**Y5**
Approved	**20,822,000**	**17,598,000**	**18,980,000**	**NA**	**NA**
Disbursed	**20,822,000**	**NA**	**NA**	**NA**	**NA**
Expenditure		**NA**	**NA**	**NA**	**NA**
Submitted to <Name of Azim Premji Foundation Programme Manager>:					

2. ANNUAL PROGRAMME UPDATE

1. *What are the key activities undertaken during the review period? Please share your assessment of how the program is progressing towards planned goals/effects. (For Y1, it should also include recruitment, induction, and capacity building of staff and community cadre; baseline, MIS, and office set up.)*

   Introduction: In February 2024, BCT approved a multi-focused project from APF, encompassing Agriculture, Rehabilitation of Persons with Disabilities (PwDs), and Entitlements. The organization promptly initiated efforts to establish an office in G. Madugula in the ASR district to engage with tribal communities in two panchayats comprising 70 villages. Simultaneously, the existing BCT office was readied for operations in rural areas, focusing on

agriculture and rehabilitation activities in 17 selected villages. This initiative aims to foster holistic development by addressing critical aspects of the tribal and rural communities' lives.

Staff recruitment: The project includes provisions to recruit 52 staff members, including core personnel, to ensure smooth implementation. A few experienced staff from other BCT activities, with expertise in the project's focus areas, were transferred to the SLFC program to facilitate the process. Following the project's approval, advertisements were placed in reputed newspapers to recruit staff for rural and tribal areas. However, the initial applications did not align with the required job roles, prompting a second round of advertisements. The recruitment process was successfully completed by the first week of April 2024. The newly formed team has since been working actively and effectively to meet the project's objectives.

Induction: An induction session was conducted in April 2024 for all staff members in Haripuram. The three-day program aimed to foster a deeper understanding of the APF and BCT frameworks, along with the project's goals and objectives. All newly recruited staff actively participated in the event, engaging in various activities and demonstrations led by KGK scientists. The session successfully enhanced the participants' knowledge and alignment with the project's vision, laying a strong foundation for effective implementation.

Capacity building of the staff: To enhance the effectiveness of the project team, a series of targeted capacity-building initiatives were organized with the support of various experts and resources. Monthly review meetings included motivational sessions and webinars on Surveys, data management, and community engagement methods facilitated by LibTech.

a. **Agriculture Team**:
   With the guidance of KVK (Krishi Vigyan Kendra) scientists, capacity-building sessions were conducted for the agriculture team. These sessions provided an in-depth understanding of advanced agricultural practices, covering topics such as crop management, soil health, pest control, and sustainable farming techniques. The goal was to equip the team with the knowledge and skills needed to support farmers in improving productivity and sustainability.
b. **Entitlements Team**:
   The entitlements team participated in exposure visits to gain practical insights into their roles and responsibilities. They also attended several community meetings organized by ITDA (Integrated Tribal Development Agency) and other relevant government departments. These activities enabled the team to better understand the processes and mechanisms of accessing government schemes and entitlements while building relationships with stakeholders critical to the project's success.

c. **Rehabilitation of PwDs Team**:
   The team working on the rehabilitation of Persons with Disabilities (PwDs) was oriented by senior members of BCT. These sessions provided comprehensive training on inclusive practices, rehabilitation methodologies, and program implementation strategies. The

team gained insights into effectively addressing the unique needs of PwDs, fostering their inclusion and empowerment within the community.

Through these tailored capacity-building efforts, each team was better prepared to address their specific project components and contribute to achieving the overall objectives of the initiative.

2. Share your assessment of how the program is progressing towards planned goals/effects.
    a. Summary of key effects (Interim and Final Effects) achieved till the reporting period including qualitative aspects as per the agreed Programme Design Sheet.

<table>
<tr><td>Objective</td><td>Summary of key effects (Interim and Final Effects) achieved till the reporting period (Feb 2024 to Jan 2025)</td></tr>
<tr><td>1. About 50% of 2000 tribal farmers in 63 villages will adopt the critical interventions which could result in enhanced yields in Paddy, Millets, and Turmeric 12%, 15%, and 20% respectively</td><td>Selected 776 tribal farmers for the first year in Gemmeli and Vanjari Panchayats for conversion towards crop yield enhancement in Paddy, millet, Turmeric, Pulses, Oil seed, and Vegetables.

<table><tr><th>Crop</th><th>Farmers</th><th>Remarks</th></tr><tr><td>Paddy</td><td>400</td><td>Proposed</td></tr><tr><td>Millet</td><td>68</td><td>Proposed</td></tr><tr><td>Turmeric</td><td>150</td><td>Proposed</td></tr><tr><td>Pulses</td><td>6</td><td>Inspired</td></tr><tr><td>Oil Seed</td><td>89</td><td>Inspired</td></tr><tr><td>Vegetables</td><td>63</td><td>Inspired</td></tr><tr><td>Total</td><td>776</td><td></td></tr></table></td></tr>
<tr><td>2. 55 to 60% out of 1550 farmers from 17 villages of the BCT operational area will adopt the new technologies in paddy and Vegetable cultivation. The expected enhancement of paddy yield is 12-15% and in vegetables, the cost of cultivation will be reduced up to 15-20% through eco-friendly methods of</td><td>Selected 565 farmers for the first year in rural areas for conversion towards crop yield enhancement in Paddy and cost reduction in Vegetables.

<table><tr><th>Crop</th><th>Selected farmers</th></tr><tr><td>Paddy</td><td>471</td></tr></table></td></tr>
</table>

pest and disease management.

Vegetables	94
Total	**565**

3. To provide comprehensive rehabilitation services to 429 people with disabilities (PWDs) in 126 villages (Rural 63 and Tribal 63) to enhance their physical, psychological, and social well-being, and enable them to lead a more independent and fulfilling life.

Rehabilitation activities for Persons with Disabilities (PwDs) were completed as scheduled at the beginning of the year, focusing on 126 villages in rural and tribal areas. Based on the baseline survey, these activities were planned in collaboration with Andhra Pradesh Med Tech Zone (AMTZ), Visakhapatnam. The details are as follows:

Activity	Planned	achieved	%
Assessment camps	2	2	100
Fitment camps	2	2	100
Assistive devices	110	119	108
Physiotherapy cases	0	105	NA
Physiotherapy visits	0	2823	NA
Assistive Devices Repair	0	14	NA
Corrective surgeries	5	0	0
Livelihood support	28	28	100

4. Provide entitlements for the tribal families are covered in the operational villages

S.No	Entitlements	Identified	Solved	%
1	e Shram Card	53	53	100
2	Sadarem Slot booking	23	23	100
3	UDID Card	1	1	100
4	MGNREGA Job Card	1	1	100
5	Health Reilief for Food poison students	2	2	100
6	ABHA cards	194	194	100
7	Health Issues	1	1	100
8	Land isues 516 NHAI	6	6	100
9	NPCI In Active	131	131	100
10	APAR	1595	1595	100
11	PDS (Ration Distrubution)	90	88	98
12	NREGS Deletion	1900	1136	60
13	Aadhar Card	385	228	59
14	Child Aadhar	1004	490	49
15	Birth Certificate	295	28	9
16	Sadarem Certificate	112	3	3
	Total	**5793**	**3980**	**69**

b. Effects Planned vs. Achieved (Interim and Final Effects) during the reporting period. (Explain in brief, what worked and did not work, the challenges faced to achieve these outcomes, and any other details.

S. No	Activity	Target	Actuals	%	Remarks
1	Awareness meetings	38	38	100	Meetings were conducted in phased manner multiple times in each village, during early mornings or evenings, ensuring maximum farmer participation and fostering trust through flexible scheduling.
2	Demonstrations	100	100	100	Demo plots were selected through field surveys and awareness meetings, focusing on progressive farmers and crops aligned with project objectives for impactful outcomes.
3	Skill Training	6	6	100	End-of-year skill training on paddy and vegetable cultivation was conducted to address earlier disruptions from a cyclone, focusing on advanced techniques for productivity and resilience.
4	Follow-up training	125	125	100	Keeping farmers engaged in training was challenging due to their ongoing field activities.
5	Poultry	40	40	100	Some beneficiaries for poultry were willing but faced challenges like lack of space, caretakers, maintenance issues, and no prior experience.
6	Goatery	35	35	100	Some beneficiaries for Goatery were willing but faced challenges like lack of space, caretakers, maintenance issues, and no prior experience.

8	Micro shade nets	3	3	100	Established to serve the surrounding villages, including the established village.
9	Agri - Tools Hiring Centre	3	3	100	Established to serve the surrounding villages, including the established village.
10	Livelihood Support - PwDs	28	28	100	After the establishment of the business, a few can manage their entities independently, but most beneficiaries depend on their families.
11	Cattle shed Flooring	126	126	100	Farmers are happy to have the facility
12	Assessment camp PwDs	2	2	100	Conducted as scheduled
13	Corrective Surgeries	5	0	0	Assessments were conducted for five beneficiaries by expert doctors, but the surgeries are more expensive than the anticipated budget.
14	Fitment Camp	1	1	100	Conducted as scheduled
15	Youth Awareness Programme	1	1	100	Very impactful activity for the youth to involve them in community development

c. Articulate the means of verification of activities (e.g. registers, photographs) and how you are tracking and monitoring the progress.

S. No	Activity	Means of verification	Tracking	Monitoring
1	Awareness meetings	Registers, Meeting minutes, and photos	Fortnight schedule of field staff	Meeting minutes, photos
2	Demonstrations	Registers, Meeting minutes, and photos	Daily tracker sheet	Meeting minutes, photos
3	Skill Training	Training module register, attendance, and photos	Selection of progressive farmers	module Register, attendanc,e and photos
4	Follow-up training	Training module register, attendance, and photos	Daily tracker sheet	Register, attendance, and photos
5	Poultry	Registers, Meeting minutes, and photos	Beneficiary selection survey form by CLO's	Registers, Meeting minutes, and photos
6	Goatery	Registers, Meeting minutes, and photos	Beneficiary selection survey form by CLO's	Registers, Meeting minutes, and photos
8	Micro shade nets	Physical structure and photos	Beneficiary selection survey form by CLO's	Photos of structure and physical verification
9	Agri - Tools Hiring Centre	Physical structure and photos	Beneficiary selection survey form by CLO's	Photos of tools with physical structure and physical verification
10	Livelihood Support - PwDs	Physical establishments and photos	Beneficiary selection survey form FO's	Physical establishments and photos
11	Cattle shed Flooring	Floor lining photos of 126	Beneficiary selection survey form by CLO's	Photos of flooring and physical verification

12	Assessment camp PwDs	Registers, Camp attendance record, and photos	Records of field survey by FO's	Registers, Camp attendance record, and photos
13	Corrective Surgeries	Photos and patient record	Records of field survey by FO's	Photos and patient record
14	Fitment Camp	Registers, Camp attendance record, and photos	Records of field survey by FO's	Photos and patient record
15	Youth Awareness Programme	Registers, Camp attendance record, and photos	Word of mouth during meetings conducted at the village level	Programme register, photos

3. For the current reporting year of the grant, are there any significant changes made to the programme and budget? Please share the reasons behind the changes made.

Ans: The planned activities were successfully implemented; however, certain challenges led to budget variations under specific heads:

Budget Variations in Skill Training and Goatery Activities

Skill Training:

The skill training sessions witnessed higher participation than anticipated, with more progressive farmers actively engaging in the sessions. While this reflects the program's success and relevance, it resulted in exceeding the budget allocated for this activity.

Goatery:

Procuring goats in tribal and rural areas posed challenges due to cost variations. Local herds and livestock markets were the primary sources, and as per the distribution criteria, only 6–8 months old goats were eligible for selection. Vendors were often unwilling to sell goats within this age range, especially during the festival season when demand surged, causing a significant price increase.

4. For the next reporting year of the grant, are there plans to make significant changes to the program and budget? Please share the reasons behind the changes proposed.

Ans: As part of the program under Objective One, there is a proposal to expand the list of crops to include sweet potato, carrot, oil seeds, and other regionally practiced crops, in addition to the major crops currently proposed for the tribal region. This expansion aims to align with regional agricultural practices and enhance crop diversity.

Additionally, it is necessary to revise the budget allocation for the 'Corrective Surgeries (PWD)' line. This adjustment is crucial due to the higher-than-anticipated costs of surgeries for cerebral palsy (CP) cases, as observed during the program's first year. Increasing the budget for these surgeries will ensure continued access to necessary corrective treatments for beneficiaries.

5. What were the challenges, (Organisational, programmatic, Financial) if any? How did you handle these? Is there any leadership change in the organization going forward? What is your plan for actively building second-line leadership?

Ans: There are challenges in agriculture objectives such as loss of paddy crops due to unexpected rains at the time of the Vegetative stage and harvesting. there was water logging in the standing crop and over 50 acres of land was under the this condition in rural area, as in tribal region the field were matted with sand and soil from the runoff water and standing crop was completely under water lodgging condition. this stress accounts for 10% yield loss even for a shorter period of time. farmers were advised with retransplanting in some of the areas where there is recovery suggested the use of biopesticides to control the pest and disease incidence.

There is no leadership change in the organization.

Developing second-line leadership is crucial for ensuring a project's sustainability, continuity, and effective succession planning. Here is a comprehensive plan for actively building second-line leadership within the project:

1. Identification of Potential Leaders: Talent Assessment
2. Structured Leadership Development Programs: Training, workshops, and Mentorship
3. Delegation and Exposure: Responsibility delegation and cross-functional roles
4. Encouraging Innovation and Initiative
5. Feedback and Evaluation
6. Succession Planning: Defined Pathways, Leadership Readiness

3. END OF GRANT REPORTING PERIOD

1. What has the program achieved, through the grant period?

Ans:

a. The program has demonstrated significant success in improving agricultural outcomes during the grant period. Notably, paddy yields have been enhanced, ensuring better productivity and food security for the farmers involved. Additionally, vegetable cultivation costs have been effectively reduced, contributing to higher profitability and sustainable farming practices.

A total of 1,341 farmers have directly benefited from these initiatives. This includes 565 farmers from rural areas and 776 from tribal regions, highlighting the program's wide reach and inclusivity across diverse communities. These achievements represent meaningful progress toward the program's agricultural objectives and underline its impact on enhancing livelihoods and fostering sustainable development in the targeted regions.

b. A total of 266 Persons with Disabilities (PwDs) benefited under Objective 3, *"Rehabilitation of PwDs"*, through the following interventions:

- Assistive devices: 119
- Livelihood support: 28
- Physiotherapy: 105
- Assistive device repairs: 14

c. Additionally, 3,980 individuals benefited from entitlement activities in the tribal region under Objective 4.

2. Reflect on the overall effect of the grant – on the community as well as the blocks/neighbourhoods you operate in. What has changed? Summarize the effects and what gives us confidence that the effects have been achieved.

Ans: The grant has had a transformative impact, fostering enhanced agricultural productivity, improved livelihoods, and strengthened community resilience across the neighbourhoods we serve. Key changes include increased adoption of sustainable farming practices, higher crop yields, and reduced input costs. These shifts have improved economic stability and food security for beneficiary families. Evidence of these achievements is reflected in positive farmer feedback, data indicating improved productivity, and the community's proactive adoption of introduced practices. The sustained enthusiasm and commitment from the community underscore the lasting impact and give us confidence that the grant's objectives have been successfully achieved.

Increased Yields: The implementation of innovative agricultural practices- Drum seeding, Line transplanting, Dry sowing has led to significant yield improvements in paddy cultivation, with many farmers reporting increase of up to 450 kg/ha. This boost in productivity has not only contributed to food security but has also empowered farmers economically.
Cost Reduction: The introduction of cost-effective farming techniques - Use of bio controla agents (Trichoderma viride , neem oil , pheromone traps in vegetable cultivation has resulted in reduced input costs by 20% , allowing farmers to retain a larger share of their earnings. This financial relief has been particularly beneficial for low-income households.
Sustained Engagement: The continued engagement of farmers in training sessions and cooperative activities suggests a commitment to maintaining the improvements achieved during the grant period. The overall effect of the grant has been profound, leading to enhanced agricultural productivity, improved livelihoods, and strengthened community resilience. The changes observed in the neighbourhoods we operate in reflect a successful intervention that not only addresses immediate agricultural challenges but also lays the groundwork for sustainable development. The confidence in these achievements is bolstered by data, farmer feedback, and the ongoing commitment of the community to embrace and sustain the practices introduced during the grant period. As we move

forward, we remain dedicated to supporting these communities in their journey towards greater agricultural sustainability and economic empowerment.

3. Share your assessment of any concerns/challenges about overall program implementation.

Ans:
Adoption of New Practices: Some farmers were hesitant to adopt new technologies and eco-friendly methods due to limited awareness or risk aversion. Additional time and effort were required to demonstrate the long-term benefits of these interventions.
Climate Variability: Unpredictable weather patterns disrupted planned agricultural activities and impacted yields.

Challenges in Beneficiary Selection: The beneficiary selection process presented significant challenges despite a systematic approach by our team. A survey was conducted to identify eligible individuals based on predefined benchmarks, including single women, physically challenged persons, and economically backward families. Additionally, interest in participation and prior experience were considered to ensure effective utilization of the support. However, several selected beneficiaries were unable to accept the opportunity due to various reasons such as lack of space, inability to manage the responsibilities, or family-related issues. These unforeseen hurdles made the selection process more complex and time-intensive

4. Describe your future plans based on the work done under this program.

Ans: **Agricultural Activity Expansion and Focus Areas:** During this reporting period, the planned activities were executed successfully, laying a strong foundation for future initiatives. Based on the experience gained, we propose extending agricultural activities to include crops such as sweet potatoes, oilseeds, and other locally grown crops in the target villages.

A key focus will be on promoting green manuring crops to enhance soil fertility in rural areas. Before paddy cultivation, emphasis will be placed on **Pre-Monsoon Dry Sowing (PMDS)** with legumes, green manure, oilseeds, and pulse crops. This approach aims to reduce reliance on chemical fertilizers, thereby decreasing the chemical residue in the soil. The practice will also promote microbial growth, ultimately improving soil health and sustainability.

Additionally, encouraging sesame cultivation offers an alternative income source for farmers, contributing to sustainable livelihoods. This diversified strategy not only addresses ecological concerns but also ensures economic resilience for the farming community.

4. STORIES OF CHANGE

1. Share any stories of change at the individual (target group), community, or system levels (*share annexures or links*)

1. Profitable Brinjal Cultivation through Integrated Pest Management

Farmer: Thadi Ramana
Village: Ugginapalem, Kasimkota
Crop: Brinjal (Variety: Krethana)
Season: Kharif 2024-25

Impact and Results:
Thadi Ramana adopted Integrated Pest Management (IPM) techniques such as sticky traps, pheromone traps, Azadirachtin (10,000 ppm), trap cropping, and Trichoderma viridae for soil health. These interventions reduced shoot and fruit borer incidence to 7.6% and wilt disease to 4.7% (compared to 20% in the previous year). Additionally, IPM reduced pesticide use by 2–3 sprayings and decreased input costs by 20%.

Economic Success:

- Yield: 90 bags (3,150 kg) from 0.25 acres
- Gross Income: ₹90,000 (₹1,000 per bag)
- Cost of Cultivation: ₹36,000
- Net Profit: ₹54,000 in three months

This case highlights the profitability and sustainability of IPM and soil health practices, proving them to be valuable for achieving higher yields and lower costs.



A B

A - Installation of blue sticky traps; B - Spraying of neem oil in brinjal field

2. Transforming Paddy Cultivation with Innovative Practices

Farmer: K. Nageswarao
Village: Timmarajupeta, Munagapaka
Crop: Paddy (Variety: MTU1318)

Area: 5 Acres
Technique: Line Sowing with Seeds Cum Fertilizer Drill

Intervention and Support:
Under the SLFC project, in collaboration with BCT-KVK, a targeted training program on mechanization, weed management, and advanced paddy practices was conducted. Motivated by the sessions, Nageswarao adopted line sowing using the seeds cum fertilizer drill, along with efficient practices like pre/post-emergence herbicides, drone spraying, and combine harvesting.

Impact:
Switching from the traditional zig-zag transplanting method to innovative practices led to significant gains:

- **Yield Increase**: 7 additional bags per acre (21.8% improvement)
- **Income per Acre**: ₹54,000 (vs. ₹42,500 previously)
- **Cost Reduction**: 15% (₹26,750 vs. ₹32,580 per acre)
- **Net Income Boost**: ₹27,250 per acre (₹17,330 higher than before)

Testimonial:
"Adopting the line sowing technique has revolutionized my farming. The 21.8% yield increase and 15% cost reduction have significantly boosted my income, making farming more profitable and sustainable." – **K. Nageswarao, Progressive Farmer, Timmarajupeta**





3. Transforming Sweet Potato Cultivation with Innovative Practices

Farmer: Vanthala Pavan
Village: Devarapalli, G Madugula
Crop: Sweet Potato
Area: 1 Acre
Technique: Ridge and Furrow Maker

Introduction:
Sweet potato farming, a key livelihood for many, often faces challenges like low yields and high

labor costs. To address these issues, the Ridge and Furrow Maker was introduced, offering a modern solution to enhance productivity and profitability.

Intervention:
Under the SLFC project, 19 farmers, including Vanthala Pavan, were trained on the use of the Ridge and Furrow Maker, which ensures uniform planting, improved soil aeration, and efficient water drainage. Motivated by the training, Pavan adopted the technique, streamlining his farming practices.

Impact:
The adoption of the Ridge and Furrow Maker brought significant benefits:

- **Yield Increase**: 5 additional bags per acre (10% improvement)
- **Cost Reduction**: 15% lower cultivation costs
- **Net Income Boost**: ₹26,480 per acre (₹9,700 higher than traditional methods)

Comparison of Results:

- **Traditional Method (Pangi Satyanarayana)**: Yield: 52 bags; Net Income: ₹16,780 per acre
- **Innovative Practices (Vanthala Pavan)**: Yield: 57 bags; Net Income: ₹26,480 per acre

Testimonial:
"Using the Ridge and Furrow Maker has transformed my farming. My yield increased by 10%, labor costs decreased by 20%, and I now earn significantly more. This has improved my family's livelihood." – **Vanthala Pavan**

Conclusion:
This success story highlights how modern farming techniques can revolutionize traditional practices, leading to higher productivity, reduced costs, and sustainable growth for farmers and their communities.





4. Overcoming Disability with Dedicated Physiotherapy Care

Introduction

Disabilities often turn daily tasks into significant challenges. This was the case for Mr. Mathe Apparao from Kuneti village, who suffered from left hemiplegia following a Cerebrovascular Accident (CVA) two years ago. Unable to perform basic activities, his recovery journey seemed daunting.

Intervention

A tailored physiotherapy program was initiated to help Mr. Apparao regain independence. For several months, a dedicated team conducted personalized sessions three times a week, focusing on improving mobility, strength, and coordination in his affected side.

Challenges

The road to recovery was difficult. Early sessions were physically and emotionally taxing, requiring relentless effort from Mr. Apparao and his caregivers. Despite the hardships, his determination and trust in the process drove his progress.

Outcome

- **Physical Recovery**: Significant strength and mobility were restored to his left side.
- **Restored Independence**: He can now handle daily tasks, household chores, and personal care on his own.
- **Enhanced Quality of Life**: His recovery has brought joy and relief to his family, who now celebrate his renewed independence.

Testimonial

“Two years ago, I thought my life would never be the same. But thanks to physiotherapy and the team’s dedication, I’ve regained my independence and can now support my family,” Mr. Apparao shared with a smile.

Conclusion

This inspiring journey of resilience and expert care demonstrates that recovery is achievable. Mr. Mathe Apparao’s story serves as a shining example of how consistent support and determination can overcome even the most challenging circumstances.







